

# FILM DOSSIER: X-MEN: AGE OF APOCALYPSE

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Phase 6 · Film #5 (Saga Two, Film #24 · Overall Film #53)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | Saga Two #24 (Phase 6, Film #5) · MCU #53                                |
| Phase                  | Phase 6, <b>The Secret Wars Saga</b> : "Secret Wars"                     |
| Real title             | <i><b>X-MEN: AGE OF APOCALYPSE</b></i> (the name of the 616 event)       |
| Decoy / codename title | " <i>ALPHA OMEGA</i> "                                                   |
| Release date           | <b>Friday, November 2, 2029</b> . Marvel's fall slot                     |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                      |
| Director               | Matthew Vaughn (returning from X-Men, 2011)                              |
| Rating / runtime       | <b>PG-13</b> (the hard end of it) · <b>172 minutes</b>                   |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>dystopian war film / resistance epic</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>THE X-MEN ensemble</b> (X-Men, film 3 of the franchise), led by <b>Magneto (Ian McKellen)</b> and <b>Bishop (Omar Sy)</b> |

| Character                                                                 | Actor                                                                                                            | Age at release |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Magneto</b> , leader of the X-Men                                      | Ian McKellen ( <i>digitally de-aged to his 50s, the precedent set for Samuel L. Jackson in Captain America</i> ) | 90             |
| <b>Lucas Bishop</b> ( <i>the man who remembers another world</i> )        | Omar Sy ( <i>played Bishop in X-Men: Days of Future Past, 2014</i> )                                             | 51             |
| <b>Rogue</b> ( <i>Magneto's wife</i> )                                    | Anna Paquin ( <i>the most iconic, longest-serving real Rogue</i> )                                               | 47             |
| <b>En Sabah Nur / Apocalypse</b>                                          | Oscar Isaac ( <i>played Apocalypse in X-Men: Apocalypse, 2016; see the casting note</i> )                        | 50             |
| <b>Weapon X (Logan)</b>                                                   | Hugh Jackman                                                                                                     | 61             |
| <b>Jean Grey</b>                                                          | Sophie Turner                                                                                                    | 33             |
| <b>Scott Summers / Cyclops</b> ( <i>one of Apocalypse's lieutenants</i> ) | Tye Sheridan                                                                                                     | 32             |
| <b>Kurt Wagner / Nightcrawler</b>                                         | Kodi Smit-McPhee                                                                                                 | 33             |
| <b>Ororo Munroe / Storm</b>                                               | Alexandra Shipp                                                                                                  | 38             |
| <b>Piotr Rasputin / Colossus</b>                                          | Daniel Cudmore                                                                                                   | 48             |
| <b>Clarice Ferguson / Blink</b>                                           | Fan Bingbing ( <i>played Blink in Days of Future Past</i> )                                                      | 48             |
| <b>Victor Creed / Sabretooth</b> ( <i>an X-Man here</i> )                 | Liev Schreiber ( <i>played Sabretooth in X-Men Origins: Wolverine, 2009</i> )                                    | 62             |
| <b>Hank McCoy / Dark Beast</b>                                            | Nicholas Hoult                                                                                                   | 39             |
| <b>Mister Sinister</b>                                                    | Fresh casting ( <i>never played by a real actor</i> )                                                            | —              |
| <b>David Haller / Legion</b> ( <i>the prologue</i> )                      | Dan Stevens ( <i>played David Haller in Legion, 2017–19</i> )                                                    | 47             |
| <b>Charles Xavier</b> ( <i>the prologue</i> )                             | Patrick Stewart ( <i>digitally de-aged</i> )                                                                     | 89             |

Casting notes:

- **Oscar Isaac\*** plays Apocalypse and Moon Knight, the same precedent as Laurence Fishburne and Brian Tyree Henry. The two never share a scene. **Apocalypse is a full prosthetic and performance-capture role.**
- Ian McKellen is locked as Magneto. **The Age of Apocalypse's Magneto is a man in his prime, so he's digitally de-aged (the SLJ precedent).** McKellen performs every dramatic scene\*; *the action uses doubles and his de-aged face.*

*In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018), who co-created the X-Men (X-Men #1, 1963). The X-Men's hidden base, Wundagore, has one wall of names of the dead. The first name is "Charles." The last line on it, by itself, reads "Excelsior."\*\*\**

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | " <i>Age of Apocalypse</i> " (1995), Scott Lobdell, Mark Waid, Fabian Nicieza and others: <i>X-Men: Alpha</i> and <i>X-Men: Omega</i> plus <i>Astonishing X-Men</i> , <i>Amazing X-Men</i> , <i>Weapon X</i> , <i>Factor X</i> , <i>X-Calibre</i> , <i>Generation Next</i> , <i>Gambit and the X-Ternals</i> and <i>X-Man</i> #1–4. <b>Legion</b> travels back in time to kill Magneto, and <b>kills his own father, Charles Xavier</b> , instead. <b>Apocalypse</b> rises <b>ten years early</b> and <b>conquers North America</b> . <b>Magneto</b> founds the <b>X-Men</b> in Xavier's name, and marries <b>Rogue</b> . <b>Bishop remembers a world where Xavier lived</b> . He goes into <b>the M'Kraan Crystal</b> to <b>undo this world</b> . In the end <b>Magneto tears Apocalypse in half</b> . <i>Age of Apocalypse</i> #1–5 (2015), Fabian Nicieza & Gerardo Sandoval, the <i>Secret Wars</i> tie-in: <b>the Age of Apocalypse is a domain of Battleworld</b> . |
| Supporting comics        | <i>X-Factor</i> #5–6 (1986, <b>Apocalypse</b> ) · <i>Uncanny X-Men</i> #282–283 (1991, <b>Bishop</b> ) · <i>Uncanny X-Men</i> #317 (1994, <b>Blink</b> )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Nerf check               | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> <b>Apocalypse is ancient, near-immortal, shape-shifting and nearly limitless in strength</b> . He <b>rules a continent</b> . <b>Magneto</b> , at full power, <b>tears him in half</b> ( <i>X-Men: Omega</i> ), as on the page.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>94%</b> . The 1995 event is pressed into one film, with the Battleworld frame of the 2015 tie-in. |

##### Straight from the page:

- **Legion kills Xavier** in the past (*X-Men: Alpha*).
- **Apocalypse conquers North America**; the **Human High Council** plans a **nuclear strike** (*Alpha, Omega*).
- **Magneto's X-Men: Rogue** (his wife), **Blink**, **Sabretooth**, **Nightcrawler**, **Colossus**, **Storm** (*Astonishing X-Men*, *X-Calibre*, *Amazing X-Men*).
- **Weapon X** and **Jean Grey** (*Weapon X*).
- **Cyclops serves Sinister**, and **turns** (*Factor X*).
- **Dark Beast** is **Apocalypse's scientist** (*Factor X*).
- **Bishop remembers** a world with Xavier (*Alpha*).
- **Bishop enters the M'Kraan Crystal** (*Omega*).
- **Magneto tears Apocalypse in half** (*Omega*).

##### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Bishop's journey into the M'Kraan Crystal** doesn't reach a **past**. It shows him **that the domain's past** doesn't exist: **Battleworld is less than two years old**. | **On Battleworld, there's no real past to go back to**.

Bishop's discovery **cracks Doom's lie open.** |  
| **Gambit and the X-Ternals are left out** | Runtime |

## POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                       | 616 powers & abilities                                                                      | Shown in this film                      | Held back (why)                 | Match     |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------|
| Apocalypse                      | Molecular control of his own body, immense strength, near-immortality, Celestial technology | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Magneto                         | Master of magnetism                                                                         | Pulls the iron out of Apocalypse's body | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Bishop                          | Absorbs energy and fires it back                                                            | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Rogue                           | Absorbs powers and memories by touch                                                        | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Blink                           | Teleportation portals                                                                       | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Weapon X                        | Healing factor, adamantium, <b>one hand</b> (Cyclops took the other)                        | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Jean Grey                       | Telepathy, telekinesis                                                                      | All of it                               | The Phoenix (not in this story) | ✓<br>100% |
| Cyclops                         | Optic blasts, <b>one eye</b> (Logan took the other)                                         | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Sabretooth                      | Healing factor; savage                                                                      | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Storm / Colossus / Nightcrawler | As established                                                                              | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |
| Mister Sinister                 | Genetic genius, shape-shifting                                                              | All of it                               | –                               | ✓<br>100% |

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## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | In a world where Charles Xavier died before he founded the X-Men, Magneto leads them against Apocalypse, and one soldier who remembers a better world will find out his world was never real at all. |
| Theme                | <b>Legacy.</b> Magneto became the man his friend wanted him to be, in a world that should never have existed.                                                                                        |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>APOCALYPSE</b> (main); <b>Mister Sinister</b> ; <b>Dark Beast</b>                                                                                                                                 |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: ALPHA

- **The prologue:** **David Haller** goes back in time to kill Magneto, and **Xavier dies** saving him.
- **The Age of Apocalypse.** North America is **Apocalypse's**. Humans are **culled**.
- **Magneto's X-Men, Rogue at his side.** A strange soldier, **Bishop**, keeps **talking about someone called "Xavier."**

#### ACT TWO: THE WAR

- **The X-Men split** into teams: **Weapon X** and **Jean** go to the **Human High Council**; **Nightcrawler** and **Blink** search for the **M'Kraan Crystal**; **Cyclops** turns against **Sinister**.
- **The Council's nuclear strike** is coming. **Humanity** and **mutants** both **run out of time**.

#### ACT THREE: OMEGA

- **Magneto vs. Apocalypse.** **Apocalypse** breaks Magneto's body, and **Magneto tears Apocalypse in half** (*Omega*).
  - **Bishop enters the Crystal**, to go back and **undo this world**. And inside, **there is no past**. **This world began less than two years ago**. **A masked face** looks back at him from **inside the Crystal: Doom's**.
  - **Bishop comes back.** **The nuclear strike** hits, and **Blink** saves who she can.
  - **Bishop tells Magneto the truth.** Magneto, beaten and bleeding, looks up at **the statue of Doom** on the horizon.
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | Battleworld: the Age of Apocalypse domain. Monday, May 7 → Saturday, August 25, 2029.                             |
| Where it's set          | Battleworld: the Age of Apocalypse (Apocalypse's citadel, Wundagore, the Human High Council, the M'Kraan Crystal) |
| Relative to other films | It follows <i>Iron Man: Armor Wars</i> .                                                                          |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- Apocalypse is dead. Magneto's X-Men know the truth about Battleworld.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed           | How it appears             | Payoff                       |
|----------------|----------------------------|------------------------------|
| Bishop's truth | He's seen what came before | <i>Avengers: Battleworld</i> |

### Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

| Seed                       | How it appears  | What it means                                         |
|----------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Doom's face in the Crystal | Bishop's vision | Doom created everything, and the barons are waking up |

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## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✓ "FAMILY." Magneto and Rogue on a hill, with <b>their son Charles</b> asleep between them.<br>Rogue: <i>"Was he a good man? The one we named him for?"</i> Magneto: <i>"The best I ever knew."</i>                                                                                                   |
| Post-credit scene      | ✓ "BARONS." A secret meeting in the ruins beyond the Shield: <b>Magneto, Baron Tony Stark</b> of Technopolis, <b>Logan</b> of the Wastelands, and <b>Sheriff Strange</b> .<br><b>STRANGE:</b> <i>"I've known since the first day. I'm done lying for him."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "THE X-MEN WILL RETURN." |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: " <b>HILLTOP.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>ROUND TABLE II.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline